Process & Decision Documentation

Project/Assignment Decisions

Side Quests and A4 (Individual Work)

Key Decision:

For this side quest, I worked directly from my existing Side Quest 6 codebase and focused only on extending it rather than rebuilding or replacing elements.

The main decision was to add a debugging system and refine functionality, rather than changing core mechanics or visuals.

Role-Based Process Evidence

Name: Jenny South
Role(s): Designer + Developer (Individual Side Quest)

Goal of Work Session

I wanted to prove that I could:

- Extend an existing codebase rather than rebuild from scratch
- Implement a debugging system using course concepts
- Apply structured debugging instead of trial-and-error fixes

Tools, Resources, or Inputs Used

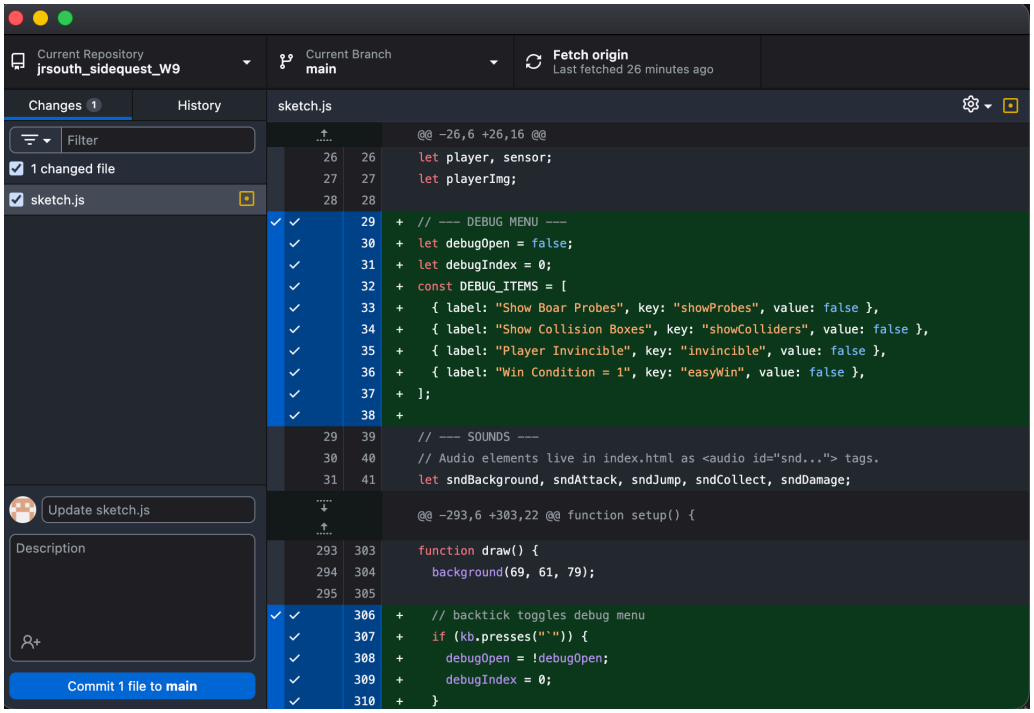
- Existing Side Quest 6 codebase
- p5.js
- Visual Studio Code
- Course slides (debugging screen implementation)
- Example 04 (Week 06 reference)
- Claude

Process Evidence:

The original game output was off-centred and extended beyond the visible screen. Instead of adjusting values blindly, I implemented a debugging screen based on course examples to better understand positioning and scaling.

Using this, I was able to:

- Identify where elements were misaligned
- Adjust layout values intentionally



The Original output was off-centred and went off campus, so debugging went into making it better fit the screen.

GenAI Documentation

Date Used: March 19, 2026

Tool Disclosure: Claude

Purpose of Use: To support the implementation of a debug menu system in my existing p5.js project. I used GenAI to help translate my understanding of course concepts (from slides and Example 04) into actual code structure and placement within my file.

Summary of Interaction:

I approached the task knowing what needed to be built (a debug menu system), but I was struggling with how to implement it cleanly into my existing sketch.js file.

I wrote a structured prompt explaining:

- The system requirements (toggle menu, navigation, overlay design)
- Where changes needed to happen (state variables, draw(), function additions)
- That I already had an existing codebase

I also provided Example 04 and a course-based structure as reference points.

Human Decision Point(s): All key implementation decisions were made by me. I decided:

- To build directly on my Side Quest 6 code instead of restructuring the project
- How the debug menu should function within my specific game context
- How to adapt the suggested structure to fit my existing variables and logic
- How to modify controls (e.g., changing the toggle key from backtick to /)

The final implementation reflects my understanding of the system, not just generated output.

Integrity & Verification Note: All code was manually integrated, tested, and adjusted by me. I verified functionality by:

- Testing debug menu open/close behaviour
- Confirming navigation (arrow keys + enter) worked correctly
- Ensuring toggles affected gameplay as expected
- Debugging layout and positioning issues using the system itself

Scope of GenAI Use: GenAI was used to:

- Help structure the implementation process
- Provide example code patterns for the debug system
- Clarify where to integrate features within an existing codebase

GenAI was not used to generate the overall project, game logic, or design decisions.

Limitations or Misfires: Some generated suggestions did not perfectly align with my existing code structure, requiring adjustments. This reinforced the need to:

- Understand how each part of the system works
- Adapt generated code rather than rely on it directly
- Cross-reference with course examples to ensure correctness

Summary of Process (Human + Tool)

I approached the task with a clear understanding of what needed to be built, based on lectures and examples, but I needed support in translating that into implementation.

By combining:

- My existing codebase
- Course materials (slides + Example 04)
- GenAI guidance

I was able to successfully implement a working debug menu system.

Decision Points & Trade-offs

- Choose to use GenAI as a guide, not a solution
- Prioritized aligning with course examples over copying generated code
- Focused on integrating into existing code rather than rewriting
- Adjusted the generated output to fit my structure and controls

Verification & Judgement

Using Live Server, I confirmed that the debug menu functioned as intended. I tested opening and closing the menu, navigating between options, and toggling each setting to ensure they produced the expected changes in gameplay. I also ran the game multiple times to verify that the menu state and interactions behaved consistently and did not interfere with core mechanics.

Limitations, Dead Ends, or Open Questions

One challenge was integrating the debug system into an existing codebase without breaking existing logic. Some suggested structures did not directly align with my file, requiring adjustments to fit my setup. Additionally, positioning and layout initially required iteration to ensure the overlay displayed correctly. This process reinforced the importance of adapting implementation patterns rather than applying them directly.

Appendix

https://claude.ai/share/c6640457-0e76-4daa-a701-1833bc39bced